

Invigorate your app with the stories behind the songs and artists, delivered in easily readable Songfacts® and Artistfacts.

Songfacts, now owned by American Songwriter, has been building this database since 1999. It covers popular songs and artists across a range of genres, and is constantly updated.

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SEE EXAMPLES

SONGFACTS

“Opalite”
by Taylor Swift

Swift uses opalite – a synthetic version of the natural opal – as her central metaphor in this song. It’s a gleaming stand-in for constructed happiness, suggesting that maybe joy doesn’t have to be purely organic; maybe you can make it yourself after heartbreak. It’s also a wink to Travis Kelce, whose birthstone is opal.

ARTISTFACTS

Gorillaz

Gorillaz are a virtual band created by Damon Albarn and Jamie Hewlett, with Albarn in charge of the music and Hewlett the visuals. Albarn is the frontman for the British rock group Blur; Hewlett draws comic books and is most famous for Tank Girl, which in 1995 was made into a movie starring rapper Ice-T and Stooges frontman Iggy Pop. Hewlett says it’s best to watch the film with the volume muted.

Very Human, Very Interesting.

Far beyond standard metadata, these facts are the kind of talking points your music-obsessed friend is always telling you about. Written by real human music experts, they've been used for years by streaming services and broadcasters to engage their audiences and make their products stand out from the services that supply only credits or AI summaries.

Available Now in the Songfacts API:

SONGFACTS®

Songfacts® are bite-sized pieces of trivia, background information, and stories behind specific songs. This includes the lyrical meaning, who wrote it, how it was recorded, notable chart positions, and other interesting tidbits.

VIEW EXAMPLES →

ARTISTFACTS

Artistfacts are curated trivia and background on the singers and bands, giving users a deeper look at the artists behind the music. Explore their origins, lineups, personal stories, influences and lasting legacy.

VIEW EXAMPLES →

Coming Soon to the Songfacts API:

CATEGORIES

Most songs are tagged with categories that can lead your users down rabbit holes and keep them engaged.

VIEW EXAMPLES →

MUSIC HISTORY CALENDAR

Skip the incomplete, obscure & rock-centric lists. Show users the biggest moments in music history that happened on this day.

VIEW EXAMPLES →

QUOTES

Direct quotes from the artists, songwriters and producers, pulled from the Songfacts and American Songwriter interview archives.

VIEW EXAMPLES →

BLURBS

Compressed versions of select Songfacts® and Artistfacts to fit in tight spaces (under 280 characters).

VIEW EXAMPLES →

TRIVIA

Songfacts has been creating compelling music trivia for decades. Every trivia experience is customized for each client.

VIEW EXAMPLES →

GET STARTED

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See how the Songfacts API works and what it can do for you. Fill out this form and we'll be in touch.

First Name

First Name

Last Name

Last Name

Email Address

you@yourcompany.com

Company Name

Company Name

Please describe your application and tell us how you'd like to use the data.

Please describe your application and tell us how you'd like to use the data.

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Songfacts® Examples

Bite-sized stories, background information and fun facts about the songs.



“Don’t Bring Me Down” by Electric Light Orchestra

Wondering why Jeff Lynne repeatedly sings the word “goose” after the song’s title line? Apparently it was a made-up place-keeper word to fill a gap in the vocals when he was improvising the lyrics. When the German engineer Reinhold Mack heard the ELO frontman’s demo, he asked Lynne how he knew “gruss” means “greetings” in his country’s language. Upon learning the German meaning, Lynne decided to leave it in.



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“Aperture” by Harry Styles

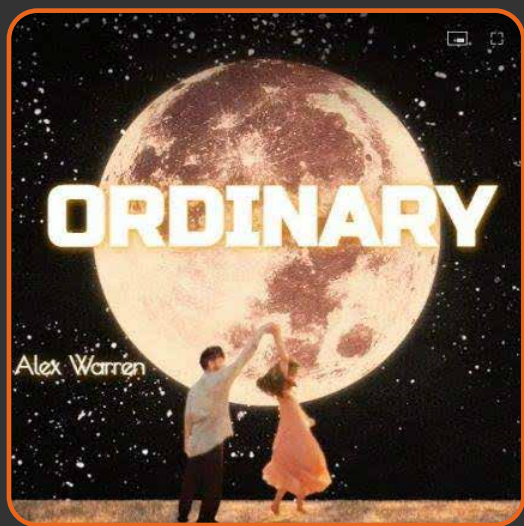
In photography, an aperture is the little adjustable hole that decides how much light you’re allowed to have, a bit like the pupil of your eye, except less prone to watering in a stiff breeze. Open it wide and images flood in; clamp it down and the world becomes selective, moody, and mysterious. Harry Styles took that neat bit of optical science and turned it into a life philosophy with “Aperture,” the lead single from his fourth album, Kiss All the Time. Disco, Occasionally, his first new music in nearly four years.



“Golden” by Huntr/x

“Golden” is a 2025 single performed by the fictional K-pop girl group Huntr/x in the animated musical fantasy film ‘KPop Demon Hunters.’ In the film, Huntr/x is comprised of the characters Rumi, Mira, and Zoey, voiced by K-Pop singer-songwriter EJAE, American R&B singer Audrey Nuna, and Korean-American singer REI AMI.

In the film, Huntr/x lead double lives as demon hunters. They square off against their sparkly yet sinister rivals, the Saja Boys, a boy band whose members are secretly demons that are using their popularity to steal souls.



“Ordinary” by Alex Warren

Warren tied the knot with longtime partner Kouvr Annon in 2024, and he’s said in interviews how their relationship influenced the song. He describes “Ordinary” as a love letter to the kind of romance that brings both passion and stability.



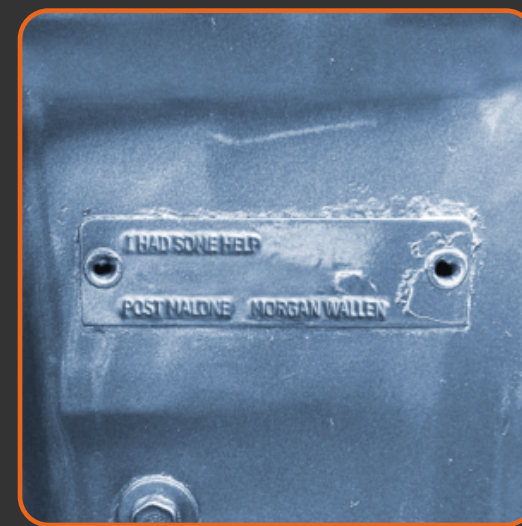
“Luther” by Kendrick Lamar

The track opens with a sample of Cheryl Lynn and Luther Vandross’ 1982 cover of Marvin Gaye and Tammi Terrell’s 1967 song “If This World Were Mine.” That lush, velvety soundscape sets the tone, and the song’s title - “Luther” - is an unmistakable homage to Vandross, a master of translating love and longing into music. With Vandross’s voice as a spiritual guide, Lamar paints a picture of devotion and empowerment, positioning himself as both protector and partner, someone who lifts up those he loves while imagining a brighter, kinder world for them to share.



“Hiss” by Megan Thee Stallion

The song is Megan Thee Stallion’s clapback to all her haters and enemies. She flaunts her swagger, skill, and A-list rapper status, shutting down anyone trying to bring her down or ride her fame. The H-Town Hottie spits straight-up venom at those who’ve crossed her, declaring her confidence and power in the face of all the drama. It is Megan’s serious warning to anyone thinking they can mess with her. “I’m saying a hit dog gonna holler - that’s it,” the snake queen said of “Hiss” on The Breakfast Club.



“I Had Some Help” by Post Malone

“I Had Some Help” is the lead single from Post Malone’s first country album. He ropes in Nashville star Morgan Wallen for a down-home duet about the messy realities of a love gone south.

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ArtistFacts Examples

Curated mini-bios, career milestones, personal stories and other fascinating facts about the artists behind the music.



Gorillaz

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Bon Jovi

They did most of their damage on the charts in the '80s but have consistently released albums since. Thanks to their loyal fanbase, they had four #1 albums in the US well past their glory years: Lost Highway (2007), The Circle (2009), What About Now (2013), and This House Is Not for Sale (2016).



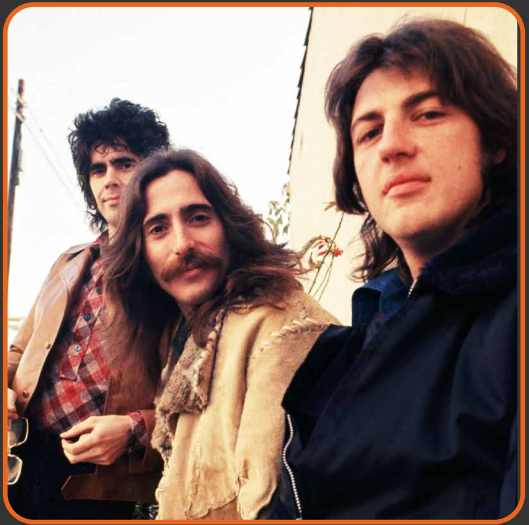
Glass Animals

Glass Animals, a genre-bending pop-rock band from Oxford, England, got their first taste of fame when their psychedelic love song "Gooey" took off around the globe in 2014. They followed their debut album, Zaba, with a run of sold-out shows on a concert tour that took them through Europe, Australia, Mexico, and the US. The cast of characters they met on the road influenced their subsequent album, How To Be A Human Being (2016), but it was the life story of frontman Dave Bayley that brought the band to greater heights with Dreamland (2020), featuring their smash single "Heat Waves."



FKA Twigs

FKA Twigs was a dancer before she was a singer. She trained in a number of dance styles when she was young, and started getting freelance dance gigs when she was 13. She got work as a backup dancer in videos for the likes of Kylie Minogue, Ed Sheeran, Taio Cruz and Jessie J.



Three Dog Night

Three Dog Night might be the most successful cover band in history. In the late 1960s and early 1970s they had huge hits with smooth, clean remakes of other people's songs. Among them:

"One" (originally by Nilsson)
"Mama Told Me (Not to Come)" (originally by Eric Burdon & The Animals)
"Eli's Coming" (originally by Laura Nyro)



Brandy Clark

Brandy Clark was raised in Morton, Washington, and went to community college in the area before moving to Nashville in 1998, where she studied music-business at Belmont University and honed her skills as a songwriter. Her first hit as a writer was "Mama's Broken Heart" by Miranda Lambert in 2011. Two years later, Clark released her debut album, 12 Stories.



Jon Batiste

Batiste shows up in a number of TV shows and movies playing himself, including the 2010 HBO series Treme and the 2026 movie The Devil Wears Prada 2, but he's also taken on some actual acting roles. He played an organist in Spike Lee's 2012 drama Red Hook Summer and jazz singer Shug Avery's (Taraji P. Henson) husband in the 2023 film version of The Color Purple. He also portrayed famed '60s session keyboardist Billy Preston in the 2024 movie Saturday Night, for which he also composed the score.



Suki Waterhouse

Waterhouse began dating actor Robert Pattinson after meeting at a celebrity game night in Los Angeles in 2018. The couple welcomed a baby girl in 2024; the experience inspired Waterhouse's Loveland (2026) single "Back In Love," which is about the postpartum transformation of her relationship with Pattinson.

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Categories Examples

Most songs are tagged with categories that can lead your users down rabbit holes and keep them engaged. For example:



"Dreams" by Fleetwood Mac

» CATEGORY: MORE SONGS ABOUT UNHEALTHY RELATIONSHIP



"Happier Than Ever" by Billie Eilish



"Love on the Brain" by Rihanna



"Misery" by Maroon 5



» CATEGORY: MORE SONGS WRITTEN OR PRODUCED BY MUTT LANGE



"Whose Bed Have Your Boots Been Under?" by Shania Twain



"Highway to Hell" by AC/DC



"Pour Some Sugar On Me" by Def Leppard



» CATEGORY: MORE SONGS WITH FOOD IN THE TITLE



"Chop Suey" by System Of A Down



"Ice Cream" by BlackPink



"On The Good Ship Lollipop" by Shirley Temple



» CATEGORY: MORE SONGS RECORDED BY AN ARTIST WHO WAS VERY YOUNG



"I Wanna Be Down" by Brandy



"It's My Party" by Lesley Gore



"Fingertips (Part 2)" by Stevie Wonder



» CATEGORY: MORE SONGS WITH A HARMONICA PART...

WE HAVE OVER 800 CATEGORIES. HERE ARE SOME OTHERS:

- » Songs written by Bruno Mars
- » Songs produced by T Bone Burnett
- » Songs covered by Bruce Springsteen
- » Songs featuring a cowbell
- » Examples of Glam Rock
- » Songs inspired by Emily Bronte's Wuthering Heights
- » Songs about a fresh start
- » Songs that won Oscars the video
- » Songs that became hits when they were re-released
- » Songs used in Spider-Man
- » Songs with names of cities in the title
- » Songs with videos directed by Hannah Lux Davis
- » Songs popular at Halloween
- » Songs that are spoofs, satires or parodies

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Songfacts Music History Calendar Examples

Songfacts has the best music history calendar – we've been building it since 2007. The others are incomplete, uninteresting, arcane, or too focused on rock. Keep your users coming back with a list of the most important events in music history on that day.

ON THIS DAY

April 25

2006

Bruce Springsteen releases We Shall Overcome: The Seeger Sessions, a collection of songs popularized by Pete Seeger. The album brings Seeger into the spotlight, drawing attention to his work as a musicologist and scion of folk music. "I've managed to survive all these years by keeping a low profile," Seeger says. "Now my cover's blown."

1999

It's Joe DiMaggio Day at Yankee Stadium, where Paul Simon performs "Mrs. Robinson," which contains the classic line, "Where have you gone, Joe DiMaggio?"

1994

A jury rules that Michael Bolton's 1991 hit "Love Is a Wonderful Thing" plagiarizes The Isley Brothers 1966 song of the same name and awards \$5.4 million in damages, the largest ever in a music plagiarism case.

1987

U2's fifth album, The Joshua Tree, hits #1 in America, giving the band their rock star bona fides in that country (they've been huge in their native Ireland for years). It holds the top spot for an impressive nine weeks, finally dethroned by Whitney Houston's Whitney.

1970

The Jackson 5 bump The Beatles ("Let It Be") off the top spot in America with "ABC."

VIEW MORE DATES »

SEARCH BY ARTIST

Miley Cyrus

November 23, 1992

Miley Cyrus is born Destiny Hope Cyrus in Franklin, Tennessee. Nicknamed "Smiley," later shortened to "Miley," she is the first child of country star Billy Ray Cyrus. She also has a famous godmother: Dolly Parton.

October 18, 2007

Miley Cyrus, who stars on the Disney Channel series Hannah Montana, kicks off the Best Of Both Worlds Tour in St. Louis with opening act the Jonas Brothers. She does the first half of the show in character as Hannah, then transforms into Miley for the second half.

April 10, 2009

Hannah Montana: The Movie, based on the Disney Channel TV series that made Miley Cyrus a star, premieres in US theaters. Her character Miley Stewart becomes too preoccupied with her famous alter-ego, Hannah Montana, and is forced to rediscover her roots in her Tennessee hometown. Taylor Swift, who performs the country ballad "Crazier" in the movie, wrote the song "You'll Always Find Your

February 4, 2024

Miley Cyrus wins her first pair of Grammys when "Flowers" takes the trophies for Record Of The Year and Best Pop Solo Performance. The self-love anthem is the lead single from her 2023 Endless Summer Vacation album.

May 30, 2025

Miley Cyrus releases her ninth studio album, Something Beautiful, featuring the singles "End Of The World" and "Easy Lover." The singer describes the accompanying musical film of the same name as being in the same vein of Pink Floyd's 1982 surrealist film The Wall "but with a better wardrobe and more glamorous and filled with pop culture."

VIEW MORE MILEY CYRUS EVENTS »

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HOME > CATEGORIES > BLURBS

Blurbs Examples

Compressed versions of select Songfacts® and Artistfacts to fit in tight spaces (under 280 characters).

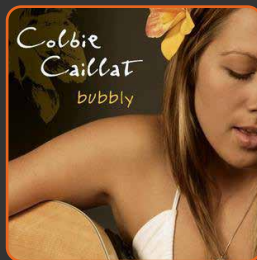
SONG EXAMPLES:



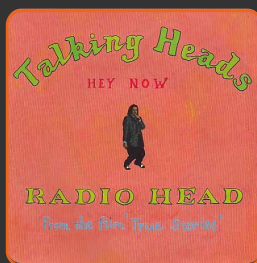
Taylor Swift used a line from "Blank Space" on party favors at her wedding to Travis Kelce: "So it's gonna be forever..." It's Kelce's favorite Taylor Swift song.



Bob Dylan helped popularize the concept of "burnout" in his 1975 song "Shelter From the Storm" when he sang: "I was burned out from exhaustion, buried in the hail." That's how many Americans were feeling at the time as they worked harder for less pay.

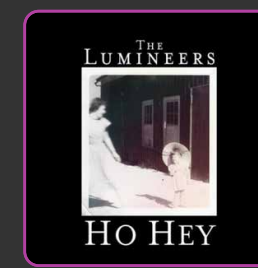


Colbie Caillat sang "Bubbly" when she auditioned for American Idol in 2004, but was sent packing. Three years later it became a big hit when she released it as her first single - the song spent 19 weeks at #1 on the Adult Contemporary chart.



Stephen Tobolowsky, who played Ned Ryerson in Groundhog Day, inspired the Talking Heads song "Radio Head." Tobolowsky, who worked on David Byrne's film True Stories, claimed to have telepathic powers.

ARTIST EXAMPLES:



The Lumineers crashed the nu-folk revival of the 2010s with their stomp-and-clap anthem "Ho Hey." The deceptively upbeat song about unrequited love introduced a winning formula of pairing melancholy lyrics with feel-good melodies. The hits "Ophelia" and "Cleopatra" followed.



Joni Mitchell stands out for her elegant songs rich in allegory and feeling. Her biggest hit was "Help Me," but songs like "Big Yellow Taxi" and "The Circle Game" hold a place in the pantheon of singer/songwriter favorites. Mitchell wrote and produced most of her songs herself.



Lainey Wilson, a country-music singer with a penchant for bell-bottoms, started her music career as a Hannah Montana impersonator before she hit it big in 2021 with her breakthrough single, "Things A Man Oughta Know" - a song she wrote while she was hungover.



Run-D.M.C. broke down barriers and brought rap into the mainstream with songs like "It's Like That" and "My Adidas." Their Aerosmith collaboration "Walk This Way" showed how rap and rock could blend together and find a common audience.

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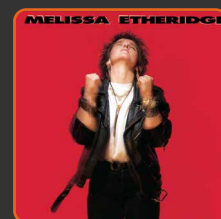
HOME > CATEGORIES > QUOTES

Quotes Examples

Direct quotes from the artists, songwriters and producers, pulled from the Songfacts and American Songwriter rview archives.



"The song is really fun, but I can remember those feelings of betrayal."



Melissa Etheridge
on “Bring Me Some Water”



"I think that I'm known for my vulnerability. I didn't ask for that. I didn't ask for some of the stories that have brought me success."



Carly Pearce
on songwriting and honesty



"When I close my eyes, I imagine a riot going on when I hear this riff."



Max Cavalera
on “Refuse/Resist”
by Sepultura



"I had won a CMT award for my duet with Chris Stapleton - one of the greatest singers of all time sang a song I wrote with me - and the next morning I wasn't nominated for an ACM for the first time in a long time. Those 12 hours made me go from 'I'm awesome' to 'I'm nothing.'"



Carly Pearce
on what inspired
“Dream Come True”



"Instinctively, musicians are lazy. They are some of the laziest people in the world."



Buzz Osborne
of the Melvins on
Musicians



"The record label wasn't around, and in those days we were so big, we didn't really listen to anybody. We could do 10-minute long songs."



Matt Sorum
on “November Rain”
by Guns N' Roses

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HOME > CATEGORIES > TRIVIA

Trivia Examples

Songfacts has been writing trivia questions in various forms for decades – we know how to make them compelling. Trivia is customized to for each client, but here are some examples:

What male solo artist had #1 Hot 100 hits in the 1990s, 2000s, and 2010s?

Elton John

Usher

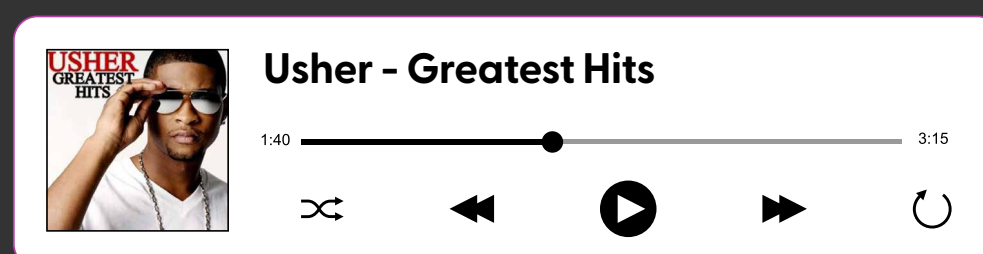
Justin Timberlake

Jay-Z

RESPONSE »

Usher had nine #1 hits, starting with "Nice & Slow" in 1998 and ending with "OMG" in 2010.

Play Usher:



What actress who has starred in movies with John Malkovich and Will Ferrell had a Top 10 album in 2010 as part of a duo?

Hailee Steinfeld

Zooey Deschanel

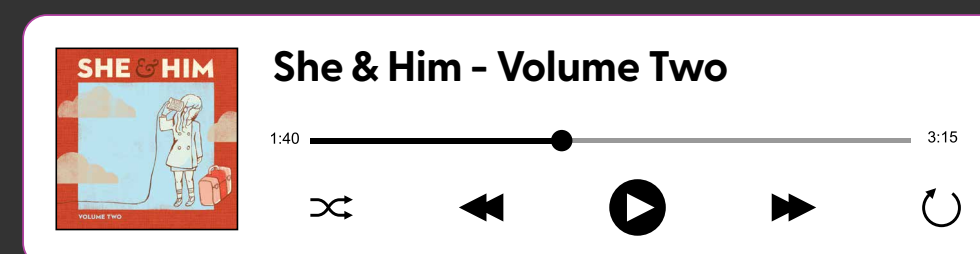
Anna Kendrick

Anne Hathaway

RESPONSE »

You heard her sing in the movie 'Elf,' but Zooey Deschanel is also a recording artist. She and M. Ward formed the duo She & Him in 2008; their album Volume Two went to #6 in 2010.

Play She & Him:



What B-52's song inspired the title of a '90s movie?

"Love Shack"

"Rock Lobster"

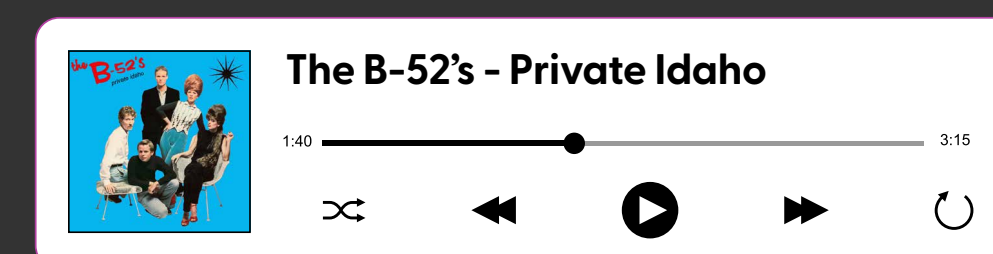
"Deadbeat Club"

"Private Idaho"

RESPONSE »

"Private Idaho" provided the title to the 1991 movie My Own Private Idaho, starring River Phoenix and Keanu Reeves.

Play "Private Idaho"



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